

SilverSneakers® class programming *guidebook*



In this guidebook, you will learn about the signature classes SilverSneakers® offers and how to make them successful.

You will also learn instructor training and recruiting, as well as marketing for your classes.





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Class programming

To meet the needs of our partners and members, SilverSneakers offers a wide variety of class programming opportunities. Use the following grid to determine the right class(es) for you and your members. Signature classes may only be taught in contracted class locations. Locations must maintain the required class equipment, which can be purchased through the Participating Location portal in “supply ordering.”

Signature format	Class description	Intensity scale 1-5	Equipment	Member audience
SilverSneakers Classic 124-128 BPM Click here to learn more about Classic	Seated and standing exercises to increase muscular strength, range of motion and activities for daily living.		Chair for seated or standing support; ball, tubing, weights	Our most versatile class. Great for a beginning exerciser or participant with limitations.
SilverSneakers Circuit 124-128 BPM Click here to learn more about Circuit	Standing upper-body strength work alternated with low impact cardio using a chair for standing support.		Chair for standing support; ball, tubing, weights	Great for an exerciser looking for a moderate-intensity workout. Must exercise in a standing position for a minimum of 30 minutes.
SilverSneakers Yoga <i>Not beat driven</i> Click here to learn more about Yoga	Seated and standing yoga poses to increase flexibility, balance and range of motion.		Chair for seated or standing support; optional ball or tubing	Great for a beginner or more experienced exerciser interested in yoga and flexibility training. Seated and standing options provided.
SilverSneakers Stability® <i>Not beat driven</i> Click here to learn more about Stability	Standing class designed to decrease the risk of falls with focus on improving balance and lower body strength.		Chair for standing support	Ideal for the exerciser interested in fall prevention training. Participants must be comfortable exercising from a standing position.
SilverSneakers EnerChi <i>Not beat driven</i> Click here to learn more about EnerChi	Seated or standing Tai Chi movements in flowing sequence to progress strength, balance and focus.		Chair for standing support	Ideal for the exerciser interested in fall prevention training.
SilverSneakers Splash 124-128 BPM Click here to learn more about Splash	Shallow-water exercise for all skill levels to increase strength and cardiovascular endurance.		Splash kickboard	Great for an exerciser interested in aquatic format. Perfect for those who may be uncomfortable exercising on land. No swimming required.



Class programming (cont.)

Signature format	Class description	Intensity scale 1-5	Equipment	Member audience
SilverSneakers BOOM™ MIND <i>Not beat driven</i> Click here to learn more about BOOM MIND	The best of yoga and Pilates combined in an intermediate to advanced mind-body mat workout.		No chair; optional floorwork	Perfect for the active older adult seeking a moderate-intensity mind-body class. Participants must be comfortable exercising from a standing position.
SilverSneakers BOOM MOVE <i>126-140 BPM</i> Click here to learn more about BOOM MOVE	Dance-inspired workout to challenge cardio fitness with easy-to-follow movement patterns.		No chair	Perfect for the active older adult seeking a moderate-to vigorous-intensity workout. Participants must be comfortable exercising from a standing position.
SilverSneakers BOOM MUSCLE <i>125-130 BPM</i> Click here to learn more about BOOM MUSCLE	Muscle-conditioning blocks and activity specific intervals to improve cardiovascular health and functional skill.		No chair; weights, tubing; optional floorwork	Perfect for the active older adult seeking a moderate-to vigorous-intensity workout. Participants must be comfortable exercising from a standing position.

Music

All locations and independent instructors need to be aware of music copyright and licensing laws. There are two requirements that must be met for music to be used in a public, commercial setting:

- Song recordings played must be licensed for commercial use.
- Performance fees must be paid to performance rights organizations, such as ASCAP, SESAC and BMI.

Meeting these requirements is simple and can be done by:

- Purchasing music from companies that make music specifically for fitness and public performance. These companies produce and own the recordings, allowing them to license it for commercial use.
- Confirming the appropriate commercial licensing fees have been paid.

SilverSneakers partners with [Yes! Fitness Music](#) and there are specially designed mixes for each of our signature class formats. These playlists have been preformatted specifically for group exercise and have been licensed for commercial use.





Scheduling

SilverSneakers signature classes are required to be offered a minimum of two days per week on non-consecutive days. Additional classes should be added as membership increases, classes become filled and the demand increases.

Planning the fitness schedule with a variety of SilverSneakers classes will help you appeal to different types of members who may be looking for either a more traditional fitness class (SilverSneakers Classic) or a different option, like a mind/body class (Silver Sneakers Yoga). If you have a busy group exercise schedule already consider adding SilverSneakers classes during a slower time of day like late morning or after lunch. When listing classes on your schedule please assure SilverSneakers appears before each class name and when listing BOOM classes, please list as SilverSneakers BOOM MIND.

Sample schedule if you are adding SilverSneakers for the first time:

	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday	Saturday
9:30 a.m.		SilverSneakers Splash		SilverSneakers Splash		SilverSneakers Splash
10:30 a.m.	SilverSneakers Classic	SilverSneakers Circuit	SilverSneakers Classic	SilverSneakers Circuit		SilverSneakers BOOM Move
11:30 a.m.	SilverSneakers BOOM Muscle		SilverSneakers BOOM Mind			SilverSneakers Yoga

Sample schedule if you are expanding your SilverSneakers programming:

	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday	Saturday
9:30 a.m.		SilverSneakers Splash		SilverSneakers Splash		SilverSneakers Splash
10:30 a.m.	SilverSneakers Classic	SilverSneakers Circuit	SilverSneakers Classic	SilverSneakers Circuit	SilverSneakers Classic	
11:30 a.m.	SilverSneakers BOOM Move	SilverSneakers Yoga	SilverSneakers BOOM Move	SilverSneakers Yoga		SilverSneakers Yoga
12:00p.m.	SilverSneakers BOOM Mind	SilverSneakers BOOM Muscle	SilverSneakers BOOM Mind	SilverSneakers BOOM Muscle		
4:00 p.m.	SilverSneakers BOOM Muscle	SilverSneakers BOOM Mind	SilverSneakers BOOM Muscle	SilverSneakers BOOM Mind	SilverSneakers BOOM Move	

If you would like to include a logo on your class schedule, please visit the Participating Location Portal by visiting: Fitness.TivityHealth.com





Class attendance considerations

When do I add additional classes?

If the classes you offer are consistently at capacity (30+ participants) then adding additional options makes sense. You may also want to add classes to attract different types of members. For instance, add SilverSneakers Yoga or SilverSneakers BOOM MIND to appeal to those with different interests than someone who takes SilverSneakers Circuit or just give that member a choice of experience.

What do I do if classes are not well attended?

We suggest you look at three things: **format, time and instructor**

Format

Is your overall schedule balanced and filled with a variety of movement opportunities?

Time

Are you offering classes at times appealing to members?
Not sure? Survey your members.

Instructor

Have you attended the class and seen the instructor in action? Have you received feedback from members?
If not, pay a visit and ask them.

Class logos and descriptions

Including the SilverSneakers logo on your class schedule and adding the name of the instructor can be helpful to participants. You can find our logos [here](#).

Including a class description is a great way to market your classes. Before deciding if they want to attend, most people want to know what to expect and a class description can help let them know the type of workout they will experience. Reference pages 3 and 4 for class descriptions to use on your schedule.



Instructor training

Step 1	Step 2	Step 3
Register on our Instructor Resource Center (IRC) at instructor.tivityhealth.com .	Complete our online Foundations training (approximately 4 - 6 hours)	Complete our online training for each signature format they intend to teach (approximately 2 hours).

Instructors must meet the following requirements while teaching SilverSneakers classes

- ✓ Current CPR certification
 - Tivity Health encourages instructors to attend in-person CPR training; however, online certifications are also accepted.
- ✓ Annual completion of the online Fraud, Waste and Abuse Attestation
- ✓ Keep IRC profile up to date
- ✓ Join our SilverSneakers Instructor Facebook page (optional)
- ✓ Meet Continuing Education Requirements
 - Earn 8 Tivity Health continuing education credits every 2 years to maintain their Foundations training.

There are three ways to earn Tivity credits online.

- 1** Signature format training for Classic, Circuit, Yoga, Stability, EnerChi, Splash, MIND, MOVE and MUSCLE
 - \$35
 - 2 - 4 Tivity credits
 - Includes sample class, exercise library and written content
 - 2** Continuing education courses to increase knowledge and instructor skill in working with older adults
 - \$15 - \$35
 - 1 - 4 Tivity credits
 - 3** Continuing education articles with topics important to instructors and the participants they teach
 - \$5
 - 1 - 4 Tivity credits
- ✓ Instructors may also receive external CECs through ACE, AFAA, ACSM, AEA, and NASM.
 - ✓ At this time, instructors cannot submit external courses for Tivity credits.
 - ✓ If 8 Tivity credits are not earned within 2 years of completing Foundations, instructors will no longer be compliant and cannot teach classes with the SilverSneakers program. If certification expires and the instructor plans to continue teaching, they will need to register, pay and complete the Foundations certification as well as any required format training.



Recruiting instructors

Many times, building talent from within your organization can be the best way to form a top notch, loyal team. Identifying and supporting talent that is already familiar with your organization, staff and members can really be a win-win. We also have an instructor job board on the IRC at Instructor.TivityHealth.com where you can add a post. You will need to register for a profile on the IRC to post. Once posted, the job will be visible for 30 days or until it is removed.

Tips for successful classes

In general, a class will be successful if you take a sincere interest in your participants, provide appropriate class choreography, and support a positive and social atmosphere.

- 1** Abide by the guidelines and standards agreed upon and set forth for implementation of the SilverSneakers program for the benefit of our members, instructors and participating locations.
- 2** Teach classes in an area appropriate for group exercise instruction; e.g., an area that is safe and creates a positive environment. Additional classes must be added if class participation continuously meets or exceeds room capacity for a continuous period of one month or 12 classes. We recommend 16 square feet of space per person.
- 3** Follow the recommended classroom set-up allowing for instructor demonstration and interaction. SilverSneakers classes use a honeycomb pattern (see below) with chairs staggered and facing forward. Instructors should face members and avoid teaching in a circle setup.



SilverSneakers Instructor



Classroom example



- 4** Options for work with the steel-gauge chair can vary throughout our classes
- 5** Participants are encouraged to bring water to class, dress in comfortable clothing and wear shoes with good lateral support and shock absorption qualities.
- 6** Locations are required to maintain and replace and/or purchase new equipment as needed.
- 7** Provide extra assistance, such as staff personnel, for:
 - Classes that are held in large gymnasiums or aerobic rooms able to accommodate more than 30 adults.
 - From our experience, more basic and less challenging choreography is presented when teaching older adults in a class size of over 30 students because of the elevated risk. Assistance from another instructor or a staff member during the class enhances the vibrancy and progressive improvement of all participants, safely and effectively. These assistants are not required to be CPR certified or to complete instructor training courses.

Pre-class setup for instructors

- Set up music and microphone.
- Let participants know what type of equipment to gather and how to set it up.
- Take time to socialize with participants.
- Announce themselves and a quick description of the format before they start class.
- Announce any upcoming events or other information from the facility as instructed.
- Ask if there are participants that are new to the class format or may need a little additional assistance.

Post-class

- Ask instructors to train participants to put away their equipment and chairs. This will minimize the burden on staff and can be an additional opportunity for members to interact with each other.

Ideas for encouraging socialization

The benefit of creating a social environment before or after class is that it fosters a community that will strengthen friendships among members and ties to your facility. The more they enjoy themselves the more they will visit.

Your instructor and facility staff can be leaders by using members' names, opening conversation, being available and connecting members to one another.

You can provide opportunities for socialization by having a space for members to gather and by offering events that engage them. Some locations offer coffee to members who might want to stay after class and socialize, while others support member engagement by creating a social space to play cards or do puzzles.



Safety considerations

Managing safety and risk in the group exercise environment is a primary responsibility of the group exercise instructor. Instructors are encouraged to create and practice an emergency action plan, required to maintain current CPR certification and engage in continuing education opportunities.

Group exercise health and safety guidelines

- Be aware of common warning signs: pain, swelling, muscle weakness, discoloration, disorientation, slurred speech, dizziness, numbness and profuse sweating.
- Avoid teaching high-risk movements. A list of high-risk movements can be found in each online signature format training.
- Understand scope of practice. Do not prescribe medical treatment. Encourage participants to consult a physician for any problem lasting longer than two or three days.
- Encourage your participants to wear proper exercise clothing and footwear.
- Cue a minimum of three times for breathing, posture, hydration and perceived exertion.
- Avoid positioning participants in a circle.
- Understand and implement emergency procedures.
- Any injury, however slight, needs attention and written documentation.
- To date, treadmill injuries are the most commonly reported incidents in participating locations. Participants should follow all guidelines presented during your location's safety orientation.
- Review and practice your location's emergency plan. Know the exact location of the AED, first aid kit, ice, CPR masks, fire extinguishers, intercom systems and telephones.
- Practice an injury/crisis scenario with your participants. Assign responsibilities for notifying staff, calling 911, obtaining the AED or first aid kit, etc.
- Exercise flooring should be safe and appropriate for movement. Flooring should absorb shock. Carpet and concrete floors are not recommended. Carpeting reduces stress but hinders movement. Choreography must be adapted to limit locomotion and quick directional changes.
- Exercise-appropriate footwear is recommended. Shoes need cushioning, support and flexibility. Footwear should provide traction to avoid slipping. Proper fit is important.
- Support devices: Participants must possess the functional ability to perform exercises in a group setting. Those with support devices may need to make adaptations to sitting position, standing anchor positions, as well as movement execution principles. Never put a participant needing extra support at risk for a fall.

Scope of practice

Instructors are encouraged to take responsibility for programming safe and effective exercises in each class they teach. Instructors must refer participants to licensed and credentialed professionals in the areas of injury prescription, medical consultation, nutrition consultation and mental health support.





Privacy matters

Instructors and location staff should follow all recommendations for complying with the federal government's 2004 Privacy Act:

- 1** When a participant begins to discuss personal health issues, escort the student to a private setting if possible, away from hearing range of others.
- 2** If you learn that a participant is planning to be absent from class due to a health-related issue (e.g., illness, surgery, hospitalization):
 - Ask the participant what, if anything, you can share with others if you are asked about the participant's absence.
 - If a participant's absence from class is obvious to others, acknowledge the absence without providing any personal details.
- 3** When talking about the benefits of exercise or coaching for exercise modifications for persons with certain conditions, speak generally without referring to any specific class member.

Marketing

In order to find marketing materials you can visit the reference section of the portal here:

[Tivity Health Provider Fitness Portal - Marketing Resources.](#)

You will find posters, flyers and digital resources to promote SilverSneakers at your location.



Membership includes SilverSneakers instructor-led group fitness classes. Some locations offer members additional classes. Classes vary by location. Participating locations ("PL") are not owned or operated by Tivity Health, Inc. or its affiliates. Use of PL facilities and amenities is limited to terms and conditions of PL basic membership. Facilities and amenities vary by PL.

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